

-- quick guide · 10 commands

SQL explained for beginners.

Ten keywords that handle **90% of your day** with databases. One at a time.



query.sql

```
SELECT name FROM users
WHERE age > 18
ORDER BY name
LIMIT 10;
-- your daily bread →
```



-- 01 · read data

SELECT

Pick **which columns** **you want.**

Ask a table for the columns you need.

***** means **all of them.**

● ● ● select.sql

-- all columns

SELECT * **FROM** users;

-- only the ones you need

SELECT name, email **FROM** users;



-- 02 · filter rows

WHERE

Keep only the rows that **match**.

Like a search box inside the table: **filter** and keep just what you care about.

where.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE age ≥ 18
      AND country = 'MX';
```

-- 03 · sort

ORDER BY

Sort the result **your way.**

Ascending by default; add **DESC** for **highest first**.

order.sql

```
SELECT name, age FROM users
ORDER BY age DESC;
```



LIMIT

Ask for just a few rows.

Perfect for **top-N** lists and fast table previews.

```
limit.sql
```

```
SELECT * FROM users
ORDER BY created_at DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

```
SELECT * FROM users
ORDER BY created_at DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

-- 05 · combine tables

JOIN

Glue two tables by a **shared column**.

Data lives split (users, orders). JOIN connects them by a key, like `user_id`.

● ● ● join.sql

```
SELECT u.name, o.total
FROM users u
JOIN orders o
      ON o.user_id = u.id;
```

-- 06 • aggregate

GROUP BY

Collapse rows into one per group.

Pair it with `COUNT`, `SUM` or `AVG` to **summarize** your data.

group.sql

```
SELECT country, COUNT(*)  
FROM users  
GROUP BY country;
```



-- 07 · search text

LIKE

Match text by a **pattern**.

% is a wildcard: **'A%'** means **starts with A**.

like.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE name LIKE 'A%';
```


-- 08 · add data

INSERT

Add a new row to a table.

List the columns, then the **values** that fill them.

● ● ● insert.sql

```
INSERT INTO users (name, age)
VALUES ('Ada', 36);
```



-- 09 • change data

UPDATE

Edit rows that already exist.

No **WHERE** means you change **every row**. Never forget it.

● ● ● update.sql

```
UPDATE users
SET age = 37
WHERE id = 1;
```



-- 10 • remove data

DELETE

Remove rows you no longer need.

Same rule: no `WHERE`, and the **whole table** is gone.

delete.sql

```
DELETE FROM users
WHERE id = 1;
```



-- that's the 90%

You just learned the core of SQL.

Master these ten and you can query almost any database. Which one do you reach for most?



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